Question cards

Worksheet 7, Scientific Communication

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In trios, give your main message in one sentence. A partner reads a card, or writes a fair question of the same type. Answer in one minute: listen, repeat, answer briefly, check. Questions refer to CareCall; adapt them to your own topic.

Type	Question
Critical	Your groups were not comparable, so why should we believe any of this?
Critical	Isn't this just regression to the mean, or a healthier group being reached?
Critical	You have one year of data from two sites. Why generalise at all?
Unclear	What about the, you know, the other thing with the numbers?
Unclear	Can you say more about the difference?
Unclear	Doesn't that depend on the setting?
Out of scope	How would this work in primary care?
Out of scope	What is the cost per readmission avoided?
Out of scope	What do you think of the new national funding policy?
Unknown	What was the result for patients aged over 85?
Unknown	Has anyone tested this in a low-income setting?
Unknown	Which statistical package did your colleague use for that sensitivity analysis?

Phrases you can use

Moment	Phrase
To gain time	"Let me check I understood: you are asking about..."
To clarify	"Do you mean the crude result or the stratified one?"
When criticised	"That is a fair concern. Here is what we did about it, and what remains uncertain."
Out of scope	"That is outside this study. I can follow up afterwards."
When you do not know	"I do not know. The data cannot answer that. I will check and reply."
To state uncertainty	"Our best estimate is X, and the data fit anything from Y to Z."